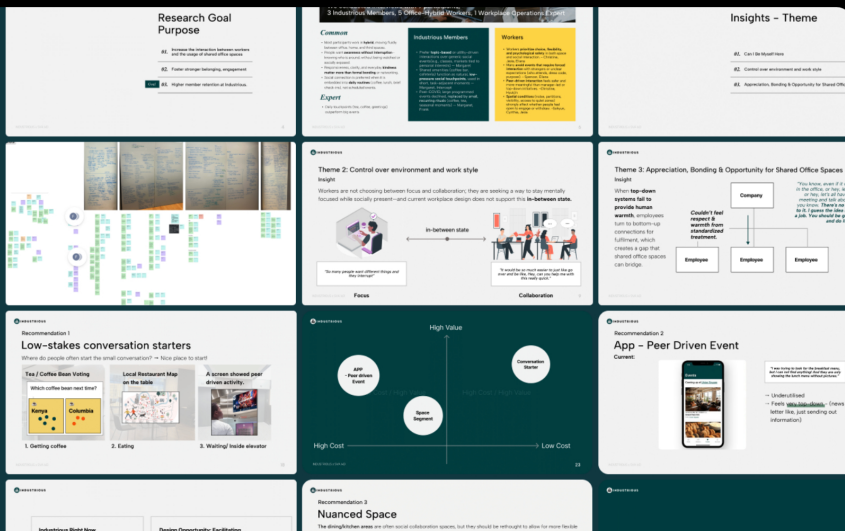


Industrious

— Research Report

UX research and strategy project for Industrious. Translating worker insights into actionable recommendations to improve shared-space engagement and member retention.



ROLE

UX Researcher Visual Design
Synthesis Strategy

TIMELINE

November -
December
2025

TEAM

Seren Kim
Sopie Lee

METHODOLOGY

Desk research Competitive
User Interviews Analysis
Affinity mapping Shadowing

TOOLS

FigmaFig
JamZoom

My Contrubition

Built the research plan and ran data collection end-to-end, including recruiting and interviewing 9 participants, hybrid workers, and a workplace ops expert.

Led analysis and synthesis using affinity mapping + pattern recognition, translating interview findings into 3 core insight themes that anchored the final narrative and recommendations.

Delivered a final pitch to Industrious (including leadership joining), presenting prioritised recommendations to support natural, authentic connection in shared workspaces.

About Industrious

Industrious is a workplace experience company operating flexible offices and co-working spaces, combining hospitality-led service with shared environments. Their spaces include private offices and shared areas like cafés, lounges, meeting rooms, and member programming.

What are the client needs?

Increase shared-space **engagement** and **meaningful interaction** in a way that strengthens belonging and perceived value, because shared spaces directly shape satisfaction, return behaviour, and long-term retention.

The challenge wasn't "more events"—
it was designing engagement that different people would actually choose.

The Challenge

Industrious offers thoughtfully designed shared spaces and community programming, but attendance and shared-space **usage** can be **inconsistent**. Instead of assuming the fix was "more events," the team needed evidence on **what truly drives engagement** and **what makes people opt out**.



Margaret Wiltshire (Industrious Worker)

"Believe it or not, there was probably less than 10 people for that whole building that came... (Japanese Stitching Event)... Less than 10 people."

Learning Goals

Industrious already collects tenant feedback (NPS + open-ended responses every ~90 days), but the challenge is turning that data into focused, actionable direction.

So we framed the work around what actually makes people show up — and what “**community**” should mean in a shared office building.

We aligned on four focus areas:

1) Motivation to show up

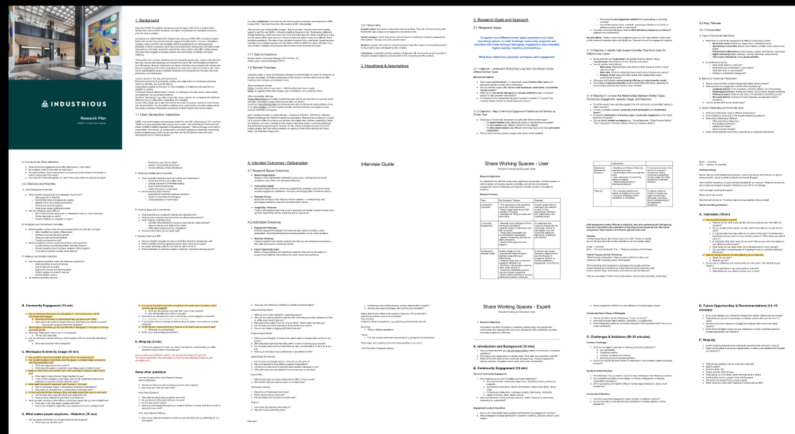
2) Engagement and Community preferences

3) Hospitality, Care, and belonging

4) Value of amenities + Experience strategy

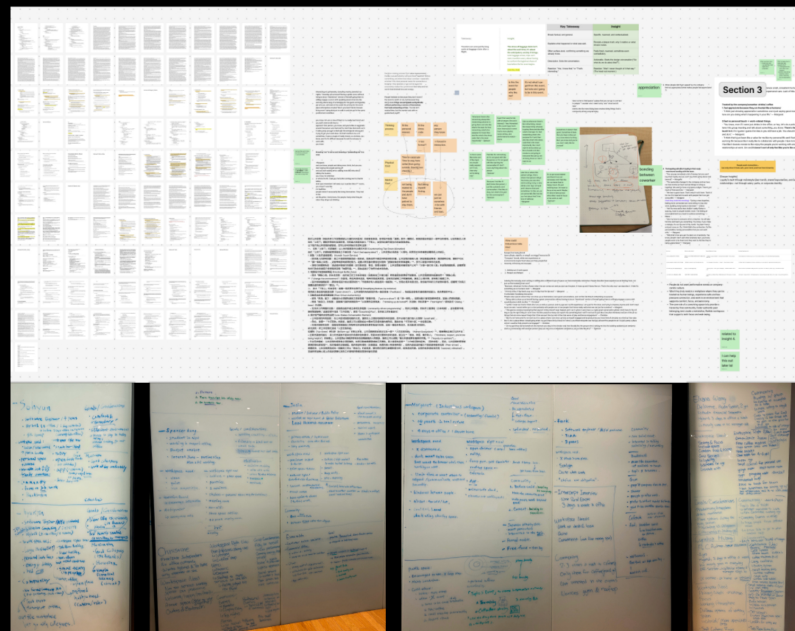
Planning

We started by writing a research plan and interview guide to pressure-test assumptions and ensure our questions could reach the core problem, not just surface preferences.



Research Approach

We interviewed 9 participants across three perspectives (Industrious members, hybrid office workers, and a workplace operations expert), converted interviews into user snapshots, then used affinity mapping to identify three core themes.



Common

- Most participants work in **hybrid**, moving fluidly between office, home, and third spaces.
- People want **awareness without interruption**—knowing who is around, without being watched or socially exposed.
- Responsiveness, clarity, and everyday **kindness** matter more than formal bonding or networking.
- Social connection is preferred when it is embedded into **daily routines** (coffee, lunch, brief check-ins), not scheduled events.

Expert

- Daily touchpoints (tea, coffee, greetings) outperform big events

Industrious Members

- Prefer **topic-based** or utility-driven interactions over generic social events (e.g., classes, markets tied to personal interests) — Margaret
- Shared amenities (coffee bar, cafeteria) function as natural, **low-pressure social touchpoints**, used in short, task-adjacent moments — Margaret, Intercept
- Post-COVID, large programmed events declined, replaced by small, recurring rituals (coffee, tea, seasonal moments) — Margaret, Frank

Workers

- Workers prioritize choice, flexibility, and psychological safety in both space and social interaction. — Christine, Jasia, Eliana
- Many **avoid events that require forced interaction** with strangers or unclear expectations (who attends, dress code, purpose). — Spencer, Eliana
- **Peer-driven interaction** feels safer and more meaningful than manager-led or top-down initiatives. — Christine, Hyunjin
- **Spatial conditions** (noise, partitions, visibility, access to quiet zones) strongly affect whether people feel open to engage or withdraw. — Sohyun, Cynthia, Jasia

Key Findings

Across 9 interviews, we found three themes repeated across members, hybrid workers, and an operations expert, revealing clear opportunities for Industrious to support connection without forcing it.

Themes	01 Can I Be Myself Here?	02 Control Over Environment & Work Style	03 Appreciation & Bonding, the role of Shared Offices
Insights	People avoid office events not because they don't want connection, but because they don't want to perform . Networking-style formats create pressure and uncertainty.	People aren't choosing between focus and collaboration—they're trying to stay focused while socially present. Most workplaces don't support this "in-between" mode .	When top-down systems feel cold, people rely on bottom-up relationships for support and motivation— creating a gap shared office spaces can uniquely bridge .
Opportunities	Design connection that feels authentic by default: - Activity-based - Low-pressure - Expectation-clear	Create a spectrum of spaces + lightweight signals that help people shift modes: - Non-verbal - Socially acceptable - Easy to adopt	Enable small, recurring moments of warmth: - Rituals - Peer-led touch points - Community behaviours that don't feel forced

Recommendations

We translated each theme into a recommendation Industrious can act on.

01 Low-stakes conversation starters

Add micro-prompts at everyday touch points to enable low-pressure conversation

Where do people often start the small conversation? → Nice place to start!



1. Getting coffee



2. Eating



3. Waiting/ Inside elevator

Where do people often start the small conversation? → Nice place to start!

Tea / Coffee Bean Voting

Which coffee bean next time?



Local Restaurant Map on the table



A screen showed peer driven activity.



1. Getting coffee

2. Eating

3. Waiting/ Inside elevator

What Changes

Why it works

Signals of success

- Small prompts where people already pause (coffee bar / kitchen / elevator screen)

- Starts with a shared object/topic → reduces awkward “contextless small talk”
- Interaction is optional → people can stay themselves

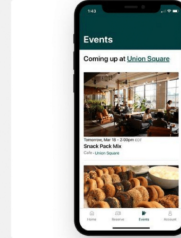
- % participation (votes/tokens)
- “Felt natural” sentiment
- More repeat attendance at casual moments (lunch, coffee area)

02

App: peer-driven events (shift from broadcast → enablement)

Shift the app from broadcast to enablement so members can host and join peer-led events.

Current:

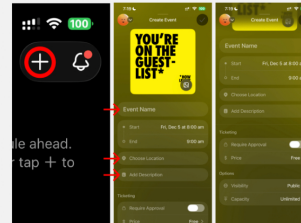


“I was trying to look for the breakfast menu, but I can not find anything! And they are only showing the lunch menu without pictures.”

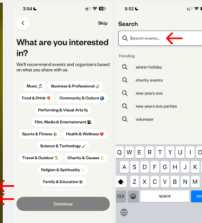
- Underutilised
- Feels very top-down – (news letter like, just sending out information)

Allowing workers to host their own event! → Finding people with similar interests

Example Features:



Searching Events:



- Allowing bottom-up connections
- Allows people to be their authentic selves and showcase their own hobbies
- More connected to the broader office community, leading to increased loyalty and investment in Industrious (improving retention)

What Changes

Why it works

Signals of success

- “Host an event” flow + interest tags + lightweight RSVP
- Optional “host kit” from Industrious (space, time slot, simple guidelines)

- Bottom-up connection feels more authentic than top-down programming
- Makes it easy to find “my people” without performing

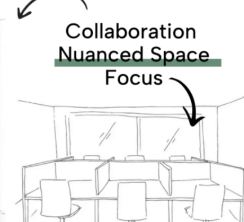
- Member-hosted events/month
- RSVP → attendance rate
- Retention proxy: repeat visits / renewal intent (if you can’t measure, say “tracked via...”)

03

Nuanced space (focus micro-zones inside social areas)

Design focus micro-zones inside social areas so people can ‘be around others’ without social demand.”

Some workers need ambient presence—the energy of people and background noise—but want to work alone without social interaction.



Collaboration
Nuanced Space
Focus

The dining/kitchen areas are often social collaboration spaces, but they should be rethought to allow for more flexible ways to work. This involves designing spaces that signal a worker’s intention. Designing focus-supportive micro-zones within social spaces



“I’ll go to the cafe shop, there is white noise, something to drink, and I am able to focus. There are things still happening around but it wouldn’t be too distracting.”

What Changes

Why it works

Signals of success

- Add "focus micro-zones" within social areas (seat type + light/ acoustic cues)
- Simple "status signals" that are socially acceptable (table signage / subtle markers)

- Supports "ambient presence" workers who want energy but not interaction
- Reduces interruptions without making the space feel anti-social

- Reported interruptions ↓
- Utilisation of micro-zones
- Member satisfaction with "control over environment"

Deliverables



Final pitch presented to Industrious stakeholders (President + CPO + Workplace Experience team).

[View Prototype](#)

Supporting Materials

Full insights report, research plan + interview guide, and working board/research archive available on request.

[Request access via email ↗](#)

Where do we go from here?

Next step for Industrious

Test + Measure (start small)

Launch 1-2 low-stakes touch points at a single location and track adoption + repeat engagement.

Design "nuanced space" micro-zones

Test focus-friendly micro-areas inside social spaces using subtle signals (layout, lighting, acoustic cues, signage).

Shift the app to enablement

Prototype a member-led event flow (create → discover → RSVP) and add lightweight, two-way feedback loops.

Build a facilitator playbook

Equip Workplace Experience teams with simple guidelines + templates so connection is supported without feeling forced.

My Takeaways

The biggest quality jump came from treating the guide like a hypothesis test: define what must be true/false, then write questions that force clarity. It reduces

In affinity mapping, I learned to tag notes as claims vs behaviours. Most actionable insights came

Frame insights as: what changes → why it works → what success looks like. That structure turns insights into testable

questions that force clarity. It reduces vague answers and makes synthesis cleaner.

actionable insights came from behaviour patterns, not opinions.

structure turns insights into testable interventions, makes stakeholder buy-in easier, and sets up clear next steps.



**Let's
Connect**

Thank you for your interest, let's collaborate!

Made with lots of bobas + sweets © Feifey Wang

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